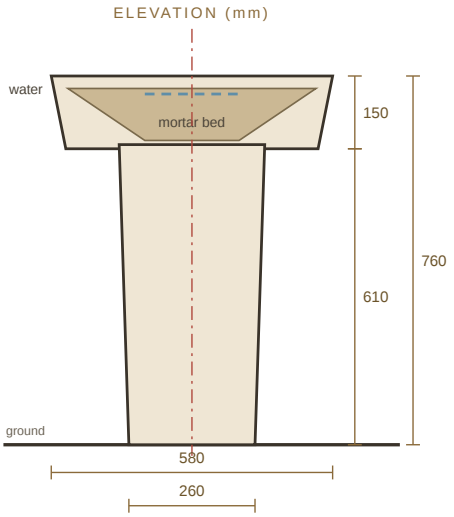
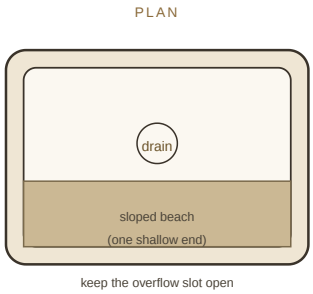
SHEET 0 · PROPORTIONS BEFORE THE DRAWING

Pedestal sink bird bath

A sink is the wrong depth for a bird. You don't fight that. You fill it: a bed of mortar and pebbles leaves a 30mm pan on top, rough underfoot, with one shallow end a bird can walk out of.





Slope one end of the bed, not the middle. A centre mound just hides the drain.

Height is the good news. Rim at 760 puts it in the 2.5–3ft band birds like, with cover behind it.

NUMBER	TYPICAL SINK	WHAT I USE	WHY
Rim, ground to top	810	760	2.5–3ft: above cats, below cover
Rim, across	560–610	your tape	the bowl is what you have, not a choice
Rim, front to back	430–510	your tape	same
Foot, across	240–280	your tape	sets the concrete pad
Water depth	130–150 (the sink)	25–40	birds bathe in a puddle, not a pond
Overflow slot	one, at the back	kept clear	it is your drain and your spillway

ORDER OF WORK

1. Set the sink on its side and tape the rim across, front to back, and the foot across. Photo it.
2. Pour a pad 50mm bigger than the foot, 80mm thick, level. Bed the foot in while it is wet.
3. Plug the drain from underneath with a disc of slate and mortar, or leave it open onto gravel.
4. Fill the bowl to 30mm below the rim with a dry-ish mortar bed, then press pebbles into the top while it is still green. Rough is the point.
5. Slope one end of the bed down to a wet edge so a bird can wade out, never a vertical wall.
6. Cure three days, rinse twice, then let it rain once before you count it done.

WHAT I WON'T PRINT YET

A sealer or paint for the inside. Two sources online disagree and the ones I can read are selling a product. Pebbles and mortar don't need sealing. If you want colour, that is a question I answer when I have a maker's own data sheet, not a demo video.

ALSO TRUE

Shade, within 3m of a shrub or fence, and nothing a cat can crouch behind. A bath in the open gets used once. One under cover gets used daily.